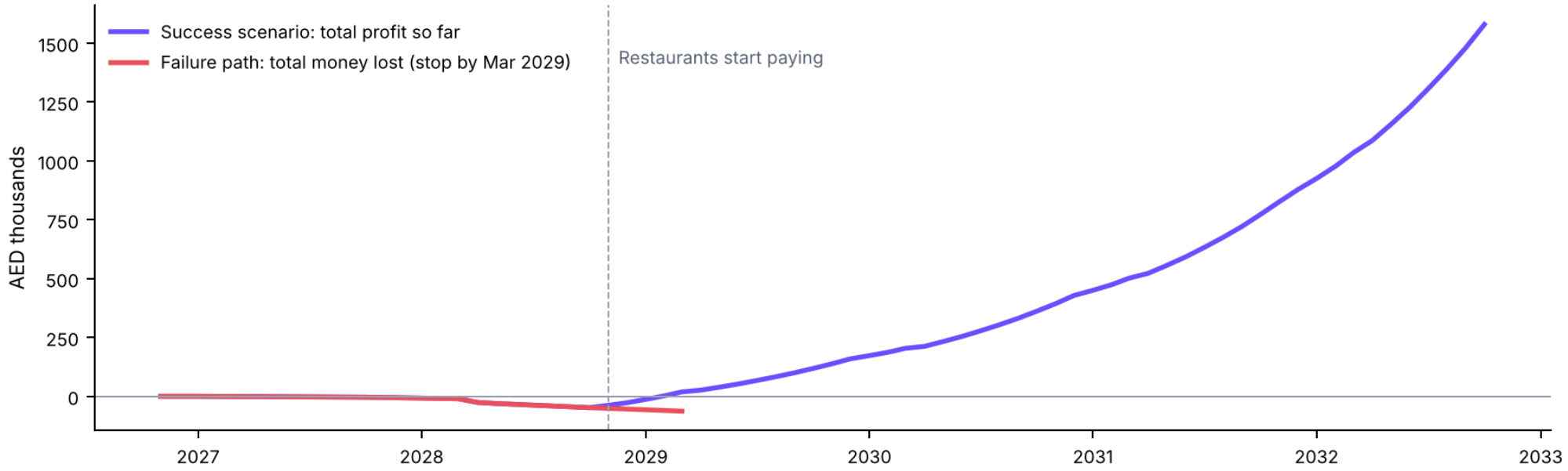
Spotted: 6-year monthly plan

November 2026 to October 2032 · what to do, what to pay, what not to pay, how to grow, and when to continue or drop

	Success scenario (your assumptions)	Failure path
What happens	100 restaurants paying from Nov 2028 (60% Starter AED 99, 40% Growth AED 299), +5% every month; 10 new creators a month from Jul 2027, 20% take Creator Pro (AED 99) from Jan 2029	A checkpoint fails and you stop spending
Money	6-year revenue ~AED 3,744,256; 6-year profit after costs and tax ~AED 1,579,478; by Oct 2032 ~991 paying restaurants and ~AED 190,061 revenue a month	You lose between ~AED 2,057 (stop Jun 2027) and ~AED 63,322 (stop Mar 2029). See page 2.
Honest note	This is a best-case model. Most apps never reach 100 paying restaurants; growing 5% every month for 4 years is very hard.	Earlier stops cost much less, which is why the checkpoints matter.



If it fails: what you lose

Stop at	Why you'd stop	Total lost (AED)
Jun 2027	Under 200 users, few come back	2,057
Oct 2027	Under 1,000 installs / 100 weekly users	3,857
Mar 2028	Under 2,000 installs / 250 weekly users	10,472
Oct 2028	Under 5 restaurants see results (licence already paid)	48,322
Mar 2029	Restaurants won't pay; stop after 5 lean months	63,322

From Apr 2028, part of the spending can come from Level 1 investors (AED 50k), so your own loss can be lower. Your time is not counted.

Success scenario by year

Year	Paying restaurants (Dec)	Creators (Dec)	Revenue (AED)	Costs incl. tax (AED)	Profit (AED)
2026	0	0	0	0	0
2027	0	60	0	6,357	-6,357
2028	105	180	36,695	57,901	-21,206
2029	189	300	372,715	186,089	186,626
2030	339	420	651,111	382,121	268,990
2031	608	540	1,128,197	679,172	449,025
2032	991	640	1,555,538	853,139	702,399

Model assumptions

- Average restaurant fee AED 179/month (60% Starter AED 99, 40% Growth AED 299). Pro plan (AED 799), sponsored reels and Spotted Plus are NOT included, so they are extra upside.
- Costs after Nov 2028: servers 1,500 + 3% of revenue; card fees 3%; marketing 15% (min 3,000); WhatsApp 500 + 2%; accounting 1,500; licence 10,000 each April; team from May 2029 (6k, then 15k in 2030, 30k in 2031, 45k in 2032 a month).
- Founder takes no salary in the model; profit is the company's. After all three investment levels you'd own about 65% of it.
- Corporate tax: 9% on yearly profit above AED 375,000. Investment money (Level 1-3) is shown separately and is not profit.
- Planning estimates, not financial advice. Check licence, WhatsApp and payment fees before paying.

Month-by-month actions

Rows marked CHECKPOINT decide whether you continue or drop. Red rows are key go/stop points.

Month	To do	Pay	Don't pay	Grow target	Success point
Nov 2026	Claim Spotted name (Instagram, TikTok, domain). Set up folder + tools online (Claude Code web, Expo). Prompts 0-2	Nothing new	Licence, ads, agency, Apple	3 Instagram posts a week; start waitlist	Name claimed, app runs
Dec 2026	Prompts 3-7: list, storage, Google key (USD 10 budget alert), Add Place, Map	Maps within free allowance	Licence, ads	Waitlist 50	Saving works
Jan 2027	Prompts 8-14: dev build, share from Instagram, reminders, settings, onboarding	~AED 50 servers/maps	Licence, ads	Waitlist 100; line up 12 testers	Reminders work with app closed
Feb 2027	Android closed test (12+ testers, 14 days) + iPhone TestFlight (5-10 testers) together; privacy policy; store listings	Google Play AED 92 (once); Apple AED 365/year	Marketing yet	Testers active daily on both	No crashes on either phone for 2 weeks
Mar 2027	Fix problems on both; submit to Google Play and the App Store; fix any review rejections	Servers ~AED 100	Marketing before both apps are live	Both apps approved	Approved on both stores
Apr 2027	LAUNCH on iPhone + Android the same day in one area (e.g. Khalifa City); start marketing; 3 reels a week	Marketing tests AED 300	Big ad budgets	100-150 users	Live on both stores; reminders reliable on both
May 2027	Talk to 5 users a week; shared lists; contact 5-10 small creators	Marketing tests AED 300	New cities	200 users	People come back weekly
Jun 2027	Review numbers honestly	Marketing tests AED 300	Paid installs	200+ users	CHECKPOINT: 200+ users & many still active after a month, else 1 retry then DROP
Jul 2027	Free creator pages launch; first 10 creators	Marketing AED 300	Charging creators	+10 creators a month from now	Creator pages live
Aug 2027	Been there + trip mode; 10 more creators	Marketing AED 300	Charging creators	400 users	Creators bring new users
Sep 2027	Notification limits tested in real life; 10 more creators	Marketing AED 300	New cities	700 users	Reviews 4+ stars
Oct 2027	Year 1 review	Marketing AED 300	Spending more if this fails	1,000 installs	CHECKPOINT: 1,000+ installs & 100+ weekly users, else 3-month retry then DROP
Nov 2027	Grow in focus area; creators; shared lists; Passport idea tests	Marketing AED 1,000; servers AED 200	Restaurant fees yet	+150-250 installs a month	Weekly users rising every month
Dec 2027	Grow in focus area; creators; shared lists; Passport idea tests	Marketing AED 1,000; servers AED 200	Restaurant fees yet	+150-250 installs a month	Weekly users rising every month
Jan 2028	Grow in focus area; creators; shared lists; Passport idea tests	Marketing AED 1,000; servers AED 200	Restaurant fees yet	+150-250 installs a month	Weekly users rising every month
Feb 2028	Grow in focus area; creators; shared lists; Passport idea tests	Marketing AED 1,000; servers AED 200	Restaurant fees yet	+150-250 installs a month	Weekly users rising every month
Mar 2028	Update investor pitch with real numbers	Marketing AED 1,000	Licence before this passes	2,000 installs	CHECKPOINT (trigger): 2,000 installs & 250-500 weekly users, else DROP or retry
Apr 2028	Trade licence; start Level 1 raise (AED 50k)	Licence ~AED 10,000; legal AED 2,000	Office, staff	Investor meetings	Licence done
May 2028	Build business page + coupon system; set Starter/Growth plans	Tools AED 1,000; marketing AED 2,500	Staff	List 30 target restaurants	Coupons scan correctly
Jun 2028	Visit restaurants 3-5pm; sign free trials (Khalifa City clusters)	Marketing AED 2,500	Paying venues for content	10 trial restaurants	Trials live
Jul 2028	More trials; simple Spotted Passport (badge + shareable card)	Marketing AED 2,500	Staff	20 trial restaurants	Coupons being used

Month	To do	Pay	Don't pay	Grow target	Success point
Aug 2028	Collect trial results; case studies	Marketing AED 2,500	Staff	Founding partner sign-ups	Restaurants see visits
Sep 2028	Close Level 1; prepare paid launch	Marketing AED 2,500	Staff	Line up paying partners	Level 1 funds in
Oct 2028	Final trial review; convert trials to paid plans	Marketing AED 2,500	Paid launch if checkpoint fails	100 paying signed	CHECKPOINT: 5+ restaurants confirm results, else DROP
Nov 2028	Start charging Starter (AED 99) + Growth (AED 299); weekly WhatsApp update; Creator Pro (2 months free)	WhatsApp messages; card fees; accounting	Hiring	100 paying restaurants	Restaurants renewing
Dec 2028	Monthly results reports to every restaurant	Running costs	Hiring	+5% restaurants a month	Few cancellations
Jan 2029	Restaurant stamp cards; creator earnings	Running costs	Full-time staff	+5% a month; +10 creators	Stamp cards used
Feb 2029	Upsell Starter to Growth when they hit limits	Running costs	Full-time staff	+5% a month	Upgrades happening
Mar 2029	Second area; Level 2 raise (AED 250k)	Running costs	Big office	+5% a month	Level 2 funds in
Apr 2029	Licence renewal	Licence AED 10,000	Full-time staff	+5% a month	Revenue covers costs
May 2029	Part-time salesperson on commission	Sales AED 6,000/month	Full-time team	+5% a month	Sales person signing venues
Jun 2029	Grow areas; creator picks; Passport challenges	Running costs + sales	Full-time team	+5% a month	Cancellations under 5% a month
Jul 2029	Grow areas; creator picks; Passport challenges	Running costs + sales	Full-time team	+5% a month	Cancellations under 5% a month
Aug 2029	Grow areas; creator picks; Passport challenges	Running costs + sales	Full-time team	+5% a month	Cancellations under 5% a month
Sep 2029	Reels discovery + budget filter (creator reels first)	Video via Instagram embeds	Video hosting	+5% a month	Reels used
Oct 2029	Year 3 review	Running costs	Expansion if this fails	+5% a month	CHECKPOINT: AED 20k+ a month & renewals strong, else cut costs, stay small
Nov 2029	Sponsored reels for Growth venues; plan 2030	Running costs	Full-time team	+5% a month	Profitable month
Dec 2029	Sponsored reels for Growth venues; plan 2030	Running costs	Full-time team	+5% a month	Profitable month
Jan 2030	All of Abu Dhabi + start Dubai; add Pro plan (AED 799, not in model)	Team 2 people (~AED 15k/month)	Cities without a local partner	+5% a month	Dubai launch
Feb 2030	Hotels and chains pitch	Running costs	Paying for installs	+5% a month	First chain signed
Mar 2030	Level 3 raise (AED 1.5M) if 5,000 weekly users, 50+ paying, AED 15k/month	Running costs	Raising without the numbers	+5% a month	Level 3 funds in
Apr 2030	Grow Dubai + Abu Dhabi; creators; reels	Running costs + team; licence	Untested features	+5% a month	Cancellations low
May 2030	Grow Dubai + Abu Dhabi; creators; reels	Running costs + team	Untested features	+5% a month	Cancellations low
Jun 2030	Grow Dubai + Abu Dhabi; creators; reels	Running costs + team	Untested features	+5% a month	Cancellations low
Jul 2030	Grow Dubai + Abu Dhabi; creators; reels	Running costs + team	Untested features	+5% a month	Cancellations low
Aug 2030	Grow Dubai + Abu Dhabi; creators; reels	Running costs + team	Untested features	+5% a month	Cancellations low
Sep 2030	Grow Dubai + Abu Dhabi; creators; reels	Running costs + team	Untested features	+5% a month	Cancellations low
Oct 2030	Grow Dubai + Abu Dhabi; creators; reels	Running costs + team	Untested features	+5% a month	CHECKPOINT: still growing & profitable
Nov 2030	Grow Dubai + Abu Dhabi; creators; reels	Running costs + team	Untested features	+5% a month	Cancellations low
Dec 2030	Grow Dubai + Abu Dhabi; creators; reels	Running costs + team	Untested features	+5% a month	Cancellations low
Jan 2031	Sharjah; Spotted Plus membership test (not in model); team ~AED 30k/month	Team + running costs	Gulf before UAE is solid	+5% a month	Plus sign-ups
Feb 2031	Scale UAE; improve product; brand deals	Team + running costs	Burning cash	+5% a month	On target
Mar 2031	Scale UAE; improve product; brand deals	Team + running costs	Burning cash	+5% a month	On target

Month	To do	Pay	Don't pay	Grow target	Success point
Apr 2031	Scale UAE; improve product; brand deals	Team + running costs; licence	Burning cash	+5% a month	On target
May 2031	Scale UAE; improve product; brand deals	Team + running costs	Burning cash	+5% a month	On target
Jun 2031	Scale UAE; improve product; brand deals	Team + running costs	Burning cash	+5% a month	On target
Jul 2031	Scale UAE; improve product; brand deals	Team + running costs	Burning cash	+5% a month	On target
Aug 2031	Scale UAE; improve product; brand deals	Team + running costs	Burning cash	+5% a month	On target
Sep 2031	Scale UAE; improve product; brand deals	Team + running costs	Burning cash	+5% a month	On target
Oct 2031	Scale UAE; improve product; brand deals	Team + running costs	Burning cash	+5% a month	CHECKPOINT: profitable, growing
Nov 2031	Scale UAE; improve product; brand deals	Team + running costs	Burning cash	+5% a month	On target
Dec 2031	Scale UAE; improve product; brand deals	Team + running costs	Burning cash	+5% a month	On target
Jan 2032	Research one Gulf city (e.g. Riyadh or Doha); team ~AED 45k/month	Team + running costs	Two new countries at once	+5% a month	Gulf plan ready
Feb 2032	Scale UAE; prepare Gulf pilot	Team + running costs	Losing focus on UAE	+5% a month	On target
Mar 2032	Scale UAE; prepare Gulf pilot	Team + running costs	Losing focus on UAE	+5% a month	On target
Apr 2032	Scale UAE; prepare Gulf pilot	Team + running costs; licence	Losing focus on UAE	+5% a month	On target
May 2032	Scale UAE; prepare Gulf pilot	Team + running costs	Losing focus on UAE	+5% a month	On target
Jun 2032	Gulf pilot; decide: keep growing or sell	Team + running costs	Losing focus on UAE	+5% a month	On target
Jul 2032	Gulf pilot; decide: keep growing or sell	Team + running costs	Losing focus on UAE	+5% a month	On target
Aug 2032	Gulf pilot; decide: keep growing or sell	Team + running costs	Losing focus on UAE	+5% a month	On target
Sep 2032	Gulf pilot; decide: keep growing or sell	Team + running costs	Losing focus on UAE	+5% a month	On target
Oct 2032	Gulf pilot; decide: keep growing or sell	Team + running costs	Losing focus on UAE	+5% a month	DECISION: grow, raise again, or sell

Month-by-month money (success scenario)

Month	Paying restaurants	Creators	Creator Pro	Revenue	Costs	Profit	Total profit so far	Investment in	Cash in bank
Nov 2026	0	0	0	0	0	0	0		0
Dec 2026	0	0	0	0	0	0	0		0
Jan 2027	0	0	0	0	50	-50	-50		-50
Feb 2027	0	0	0	0	507	-507	-557		-557
Mar 2027	0	0	0	0	150	-150	-707		-707
Apr 2027	0	0	0	0	450	-450	-1,157		-1,157
May 2027	0	0	0	0	450	-450	-1,607		-1,607
Jun 2027	0	0	0	0	450	-450	-2,057		-2,057
Jul 2027	0	10	0	0	450	-450	-2,507		-2,507
Aug 2027	0	20	0	0	450	-450	-2,957		-2,957
Sep 2027	0	30	0	0	450	-450	-3,407		-3,407
Oct 2027	0	40	0	0	450	-450	-3,857		-3,857
Nov 2027	0	50	0	0	1,250	-1,250	-5,107		-5,107
Dec 2027	0	60	0	0	1,250	-1,250	-6,357		-6,357
Jan 2028	0	70	0	0	1,250	-1,250	-7,607		-7,607
Feb 2028	0	80	0	0	1,615	-1,615	-9,222		-9,222
Mar 2028	0	90	0	0	1,250	-1,250	-10,472		-10,472
Apr 2028	0	100	0	0	15,550	-15,550	-26,022	50,000	23,978
May 2028	0	110	0	0	4,550	-4,550	-30,572		19,428
Jun 2028	0	120	0	0	3,550	-3,550	-34,122		15,878
Jul 2028	0	130	0	0	3,550	-3,550	-37,672		12,328
Aug 2028	0	140	0	0	3,550	-3,550	-41,222		8,778
Sep 2028	0	150	0	0	3,550	-3,550	-44,772		5,228
Oct 2028	0	160	0	0	3,550	-3,550	-48,322		1,678
Nov 2028	100	170	0	17,900	7,932	9,968	-38,354		11,646
Dec 2028	105	180	0	18,795	8,004	10,791	-27,563		22,437
Jan 2029	110	190	38	23,452	8,894	14,558	-13,005		36,995
Feb 2029	116	200	40	24,724	9,552	15,172	2,168		52,168
Mar 2029	122	210	42	25,996	9,479	16,517	18,685	250,000	318,685
Apr 2029	128	220	44	27,268	19,772	7,496	26,181		326,181
May 2029	134	230	46	28,540	16,064	12,476	38,657		338,657
Jun 2029	141	240	48	29,991	16,398	13,593	52,250		352,250
Jul 2029	148	250	50	31,442	16,732	14,710	66,960		366,960

Month	Paying restaurants	Creators	Creator Pro	Revenue	Costs	Profit	Total profit so far	Investment in	Cash in bank
Aug 2029	155	260	52	32,893	17,065	15,828	82,788		382,788
Sep 2029	163	270	54	34,523	17,440	17,083	99,871		399,871
Oct 2029	171	280	56	36,153	17,815	18,338	118,209		418,209
Nov 2029	180	290	58	37,962	18,231	19,731	137,939		437,939
Dec 2029	189	300	60	39,771	18,647	21,124	159,063		459,063
Jan 2030	198	310	62	41,580	28,063	13,517	172,580		472,580
Feb 2030	208	320	64	43,568	28,886	14,682	187,262		487,262
Mar 2030	218	330	66	45,556	28,978	16,578	203,840	1,500,000	2,003,840
Apr 2030	229	340	68	47,723	39,476	8,247	212,087		2,012,087
May 2030	241	350	70	50,069	30,016	20,053	232,140		2,032,140
Jun 2030	253	360	72	52,415	30,555	21,860	253,999		2,053,999
Jul 2030	265	370	74	54,761	31,095	23,666	277,665		2,077,665
Aug 2030	279	380	76	57,465	31,717	25,748	303,413		2,103,413
Sep 2030	293	390	78	60,169	32,339	27,830	331,244		2,131,244
Oct 2030	307	400	80	62,873	32,961	29,912	361,156		2,161,156
Nov 2030	323	410	82	65,935	33,665	32,270	393,426		2,193,426
Dec 2030	339	420	84	68,997	34,369	34,628	428,053		2,228,053
Jan 2031	356	430	86	72,238	50,115	22,123	450,177		2,250,177
Feb 2031	373	440	88	75,479	51,225	24,254	474,431		2,274,431
Mar 2031	392	450	90	79,078	51,688	27,390	501,821		2,301,821
Apr 2031	412	460	92	82,856	62,557	20,299	522,120		2,322,120
May 2031	432	470	94	86,634	53,426	33,208	555,328		2,355,328
Jun 2031	454	480	96	90,770	54,377	36,393	591,721		2,391,721
Jul 2031	476	490	98	94,906	55,328	39,578	631,298		2,431,298
Aug 2031	500	500	100	99,400	56,362	43,038	674,336		2,474,336
Sep 2031	525	510	102	104,073	57,437	46,636	720,973		2,520,973
Oct 2031	552	520	104	109,104	58,594	50,510	771,483		2,571,483
Nov 2031	579	530	106	114,135	59,751	54,384	825,867		2,625,867
Dec 2031	608	540	108	119,524	68,312	51,212	877,079		2,677,079
Jan 2032	639	550	110	125,271	77,312	47,959	925,038		2,725,038
Feb 2032	670	560	112	131,018	78,999	52,019	977,056		2,777,056
Mar 2032	704	570	114	137,302	80,079	57,223	1,034,279		2,834,279
Apr 2032	739	580	116	143,765	91,566	52,199	1,086,478		2,886,478
May 2032	776	590	118	150,586	83,135	67,451	1,153,929		2,953,929
Jun 2032	815	600	120	157,765	84,786	72,979	1,226,908		3,026,908

Month	Paying restaurants	Creators	Creator Pro	Revenue	Costs	Profit	Total profit so far	Investment in	Cash in bank
Jul 2032	856	610	122	165,302	86,519	78,783	1,305,691		3,105,691
Aug 2032	899	620	124	173,197	88,335	84,862	1,390,553		3,190,553
Sep 2032	943	630	126	181,271	90,192	91,079	1,481,631		3,281,631
Oct 2032	991	640	128	190,061	92,214	97,847	1,579,478		3,379,478

All amounts in AED. Green row: restaurants start paying. Costs include tax in December rows.